

Crocodile

Crocodylus niloticus

Least Concern

Fact Sheet · Colouring Page · Activities

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Crocodile — Fact Sheet

Scientific name	Crocodylus niloticus
Conservation status	Least Concern
Region	Sub-Saharan Africa and Madagascar
Habitat	Freshwater rivers, lakes, marshes, and estuaries across Sub-Saharan Africa
Diet	Carnivore — fish, mammals (wildebeest, zebra), birds, and reptiles; an ambush predator
Weight	220–750 kg
Size	3.5–5 m length
Lifespan	70–100 years in the wild
Wild population	Around 250,000–500,000 Nile crocodiles worldwide

Did You Know?

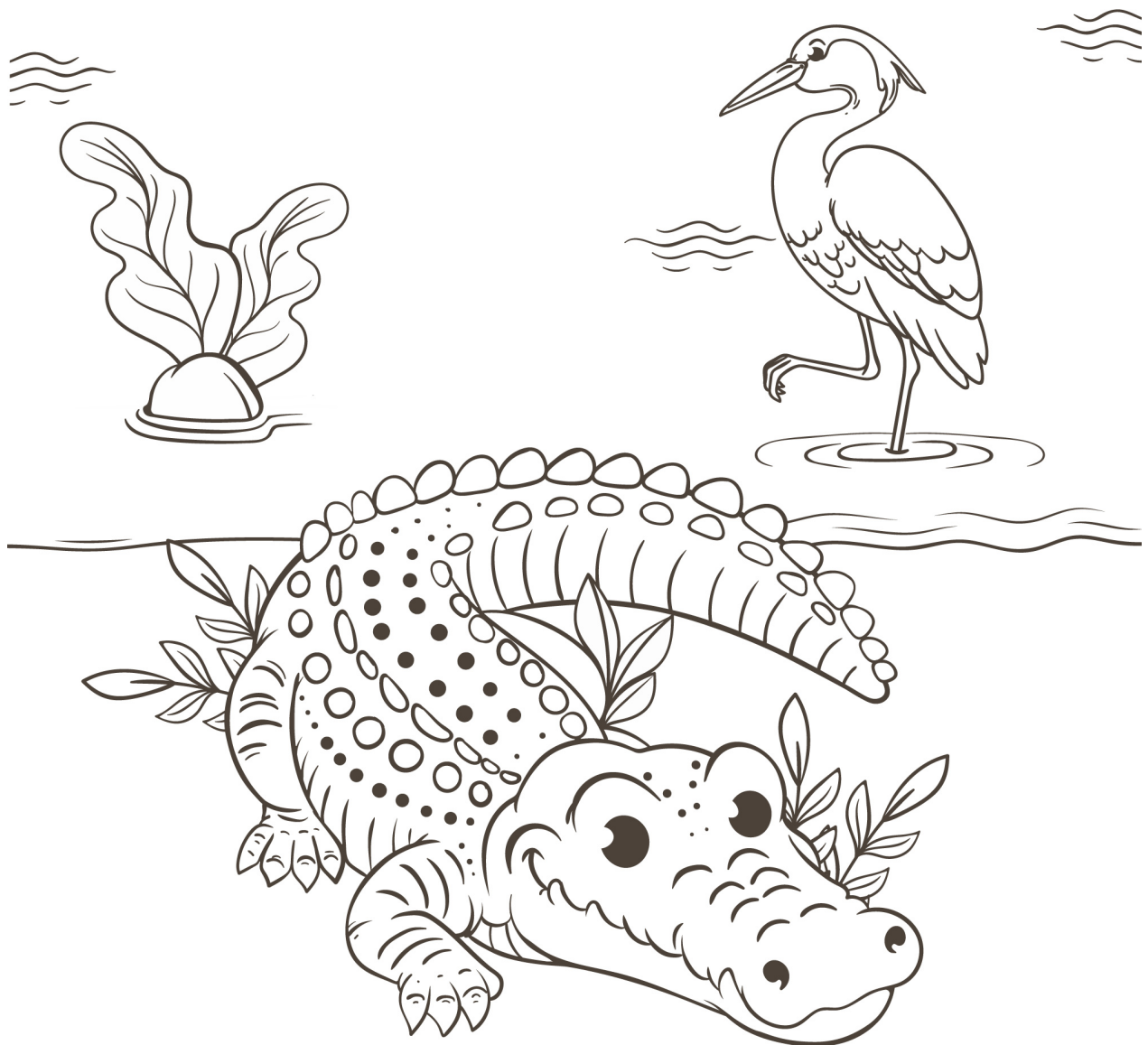
- Crocodiles have been on Earth for over 200 million years — they outlived the dinosaurs!
- They have the most powerful bite of any living animal (force of 16,000 N), yet cannot chew — they swallow prey whole or spin to tear chunks off.
- Crocodiles bask with their mouths open to cool down — not because they are yawning!
- Female crocodiles are attentive mothers — they carry hatchlings gently in their mouths to the water.
- They can slow their metabolism so much that they can survive months without eating after a big meal.
- Crocodile teeth are hollow and replaced continuously — they can go through 50 sets in a lifetime!

Threats to Survival

1. Hunting for skin, meat, and traditional medicine
2. Habitat loss from agriculture and dam construction
3. Pollution of rivers and wetlands
4. Human–crocodile conflict near rivers and settlements

Colour Me: Crocodile

Crocodiles are dark olive-green to brown on top with a lighter yellow-cream underside. Their armoured skin forms raised bumpy scutes.



Crocodile — Activities

Word Search

Find all 8 words hidden in the grid.

S	P	U	W	E	T	L	A	N	D	T	T
G	C	U	X	V	W	I	T	M	V	C	M
B	U	A	J	M	E	H	F	A	J	R	T
I	J	B	L	B	B	Y	A	I	K	O	E
J	P	T	U	E	B	O	M	V	Y	C	B
O	M	S	E	D	S	F	B	A	L	O	B
O	Q	R	N	E	E	B	U	F	W	D	D
F	L	J	L	K	T	L	S	R	W	I	W
R	N	M	S	R	L	H	H	I	M	L	Q
I	E	N	I	L	E	Z	X	C	M	E	T
I	F	S	K	Q	K	I	W	A	I	A	Q
T	X	R	E	P	T	I	L	E	R	S	E

CROCODILE	REPTILE	AMBUSH	NILE
TEETH	AFRICA	SCALES	WETLAND

Match It Up

Draw a line from each word on the left to its meaning on the right.

Crocodile		waiting quietly to catch prey
Nile		Africa's longest river
Ambush		has survived 200 million years
Basking		a baby crocodile
Hatchling		warming up in the sun

Fill in the Blanks

1. Crocodiles have been on Earth for over _____ million years.
2. Female crocodiles carry their babies in their _____.
3. The Nile crocodile is found in _____ Africa.
4. Crocodiles are _____ predators — they wait then strike.

Answers: 200 / mouths / Sub-Saharan / ambush

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